



MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

A Reconciling Congregation

WE SEEK, WE SERVE, WE CELEBRATE

December 13, 2020

Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

If you are new to our church community,
please fill out some information about yourself in the "visitor" tab of our website.
You can learn a little bit more about us, and get yourself added to our email information lists.

Greeting

Lighting of the Advent Wreath

Candle Lighters: Rose Gruenhagen & Kevin Bruns

Song of Response:

Peace, Peace, Peace on Earth
Peace, peace, peace on earth and good will to all
this is a time for joy
this is a time for love
now let us all sing together
of peace, peace, peace on earth

Prayers

Sharing Joys and Concerns

Morning Prayer

(adapted from Touch Holiness, ed. Ruth C. Duck & Maren C. Tirabassi)

God of love and power, we come to you for healing. Where relationships are full of stress and unkind words shatter the spirit, grant reconciliation and renewal. When the load seems too heavy and our backs are tight with pressure, place on us your yoke, which is easy, and your burden, which is light. When change comes too fast and too painfully, and our lives are all in pieces, help us to shape ourselves anew out of the fragments. Help us to see you throughout this world, O God of Advent, and of all times. Amen.

Silent Prayers

The Lord's Prayer

inclusive

**Our Creator, God in heaven, hallowed be thy name.
Thy kin-dom* come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us.
Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kin-dom and the power and the glory forever. Amen.**

**Kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.*

Children's Message

Jenia Strom

Passing the Peace

Congregational Hymn

Led by Alex Rack and Anders Nelson

Joy to the World

The United Methodist Hymnal

Isaac Watts 1719

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Joy to the world, the Lord is come!
Let earth receive her King;
let every heart prepare him room,
and heaven and nature sing,
and heaven and nature sing,
and heaven, and heaven, and nature sing.

Joy to the world, the Savior reigns!
Let all their songs employ;
while fields and floods, rocks, hills, and plains
repeat the sounding joy,
repeat the sounding joy,
repeat, repeat the sounding joy.

No more let sins and sorrows grow,
nor thorns infest the ground;
he comes to make his blessings flow
far as the curse is found,
far as the curse is found,
far as, far as the curse is found.

He rules the world with truth and grace,
and makes the nations prove
the glories of his righteousness,
and wonders of his love,
and wonders of his love,
and wonders, and wonders of his love.

Offertory

Anders Nelson, *organ*

He Whom Shepherd Men Came Praising

Paul Manz (ASCAP)

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Scripture Lesson

Paige Gruenhagen

Isaiah 61:1-4, 8-11

Message

“To Practice Joy”

Traveling Music

Alex Rack, *Lead Vocals and Ukulele*; Colleen Cowie, *Bass and Backup Vocals*

Blue Christmas

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Benediction

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;

Jenia Strom, *Program Director of Children, Youth, and Families*

Alex Rack, *Choir Director*; Anders Nelson, *Organist*; Tim Siefkes and Josh Espinosa, *Contemporary Band Leaders*;

Nicholas Sabah, *Communion Steward*

Thank you to: Dean Ammerman & Pete Ketcham for video production and Anders Nelson & Tim Siefkes for music production

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Announcements

New in our prayers this week:

- **Deaths:** Elsie Braunig (*Allison Jessee's grandmother*) on Dec. 6.

Holding in prayer:

- **Hospitalized:** Arlyne Forsberg (*Diane Enge's mother*) with Covid-19.
- **Prayers of Care:** Gary Claude (*Sue Claude's father*)
- **Receiving treatment for cancer:** Scott Christianson (*son-in-law of Mary Doelz*), Joan Ellison, Jordyn Meskan (*niece of Elaine Chadwick*), David Miller (*father of Kevin Miller*), Carol Spearman, Wanda (*friend of Kim Neal*)
- **Healthcare workers:** Rene Cronquist, Deb Diko, Emma Dolphin, Andrea Ghizoni, Maggie Kappelman, Chloe Kennedy-Abdella, Quinn Kennedy-Abdella, Erinn Kennedy-Heldt, Paula Kocken, Kayla Hicks, Trevor Hicks, Peter Johnson, Sue Johnson, Dan Nelson, Fred Peterson, Amy Ralph, D.R. Schroeder
- **Educators:** Beth Anderson, Jill Carlton, Joy Collman, Jason Emrick, Hayley Forrest, Rachel Hansberry, Tori Holtz, Allison Jessee, Tanya Ketcham, Peggy Kirkpatrick, Rita Miller, Kim Moren, Matthew Palombo, Alex Rack, Eric Strom, Meredith Webb, Marisa Zimmerman
- **Partnership Families:** The Dauds and Omars

Toy Drive Donations Needed

During the 4 Tuesdays before Christmas, Food Shelf Parents are able to select toys for their children, ranging from babies to teenagers. Parents may choose a toy (ranging from baby toys to dolls to hot wheels to table foosball to hair dryers and clock radios), a stocking stuffer, and a hat or gloves for each of their children. We also provide gift bags and wrapping paper. All this is made possible by the generosity of members of Minnehaha. *Every year, parents respond with "Thank you, thank you, thank you!" and "Oh my gosh, these present are so nice!" and "Can I really get a hat and gloves for each of my children?"* There are three ways you can help with this mission:

- Buy toys, hats, and gloves- as our office hours are limited a great time to drop off toys is during MinneHarvest. To arrange another drop off time contact Renee Beymer
- Write a check to the church (put Toys in the memo line) or give through our Donate button on the website and designate it for Christmas Toys

With your help Good Things will, indeed, continue to Happen Here

Still looking for a Christmas gift? Minnehaha UMW has some items that would be great gifts: 1 pound of fantastic Wild Rice for \$15, 2 pounds for \$30, Bean soup mixes, \$5, Minnehaha UMW Cookbooks for \$5, kitchen towels with crocheted handles for \$7.50, net scrubbies \$2 and a variety of different homemade jams/jellies \$4. Please order by calling Maureen Trepp at 612-387-2520 (leave a message!), or maureentrepp@yahoo.com and we'll find a way to deliver and collect payment. All proceeds go to the missions supported by the UMW.